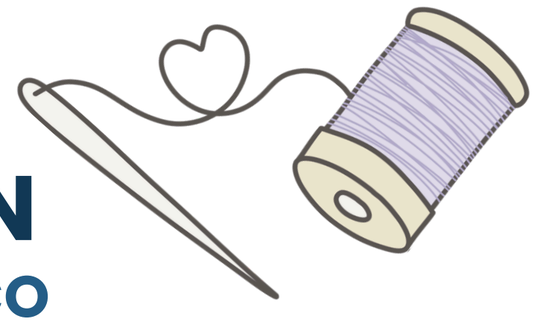
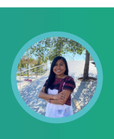
EMBROIDERY, RESISTANCE AND AUTONOMY OF INDIGENOUS WOMEN IN MEXICO



INTRODUCTION

Socioeconomic Context: Cuetzalan del Progreso has a poverty rate of 82.4% and an informal labor rate of 80%. Nahua women face a gendered division of labor in which they take on domestic and caregiving responsibilities.

Theoretical Framework: The Social and Solidarity Economy (SSE) (Coraggio, 2011) proposes prioritizing labor over capital. However, drawing on Social Reproduction Theory (Bhattacharya, 2017) and the concept of the Coloniality of Gender (Lugones, 2008), it is clear that gaining access to an income does not automatically ensure equity within the household; instead, it can lead to a "double" or "triple burden" of labor if there is no shared responsibility.



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SOCIAL PROBLEM:

In the indigenous nahuas communities of Cuetzalan del Progreso, structural poverty (82.4%) and high marginalization confine populations to precarious subsistence economies. This vulnerability disproportionately affects women, who endure intersecting inequalities of class, ethnicity, and gender under a patriarchal system that subordinates them within the domestic sphere while relying on their unremunerated labor.

GENERAL OBJECTIVE:

To analyze the Ika-Noj-May Solidarity Group across two dimensions: first, by examining its formation process and organizational structure; and second, by investigating the contributions and tensions associated with the members' participation—specifically regarding their family well-being, the distribution of unpaid household labor, and their autonomy in decision-making.

1. Approach
2. Questionnaires (20/50)
3. Interviews (9)
4. Analysis

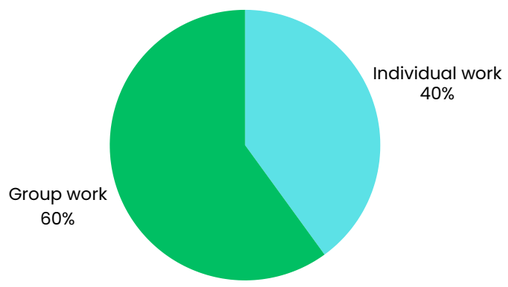
METHODOLOGY

- **Approach:** Mixed, cross-cutting, comparative, and observational.
- **Sample:**
- **Quantitative**: n = 50
- Likert-scale questionnaires (preliminary results from the first 20: 10 associated with Ika-Noj-May and 10 independent).
- **Qualitative:** n= 9 Semi-structured interviews with founders/directors.

PRELIMINARY RESULTS

Autonomy in Household Decision-Making (%)

90% of the members of Ika-Noj-May make spending decisions either autonomously or jointly with their partners, compared to 60% among independent artisans.

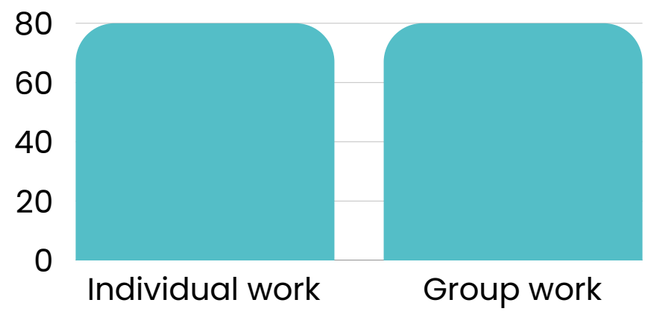


"Economic income alone does not automatically translate into equity, nor does it reduce the double burden of unpaid work shouldered by women."

The qualitative and comparative findings indicate that membership in the Ika-Noj-May collective fosters strong personal autonomy, mutual emotional backing, and community identity. However, empirical data reveal a persistent structural tension: collective economic participation does not automatically transform the sexual division of labor, as women continue to shoulder heavy domestic and care burdens amid limited familial co-responsibility.

DOMESTIC WORKDAY

Regardless of whether the artisans work in a group or individually, they each perform more than 4 hours of unpaid domestic work.



CONCLUSIONS

Affiliation with the Ika-Noj-May collective significantly strengthens biocultural identity, self-esteem, and autonomy within the public sphere and in decision-making spaces. However, a patriarchal and colonial contradiction persists: collective economic earnings do not automatically reorganize the gender-based division of labor within the household.

TECHNOLOGICAL REFLECTIONS

- Evaluate quarterly performance closely against set milestones.
- Reallocate marketing spend toward high-yielding acquisition channels.
- Enhance onboarding flows to drive immediate software adoption.
- Develop risk mitigation and contingency playbooks for key accounts.

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